

of whom 10 did not meet the inclusion criteria. However, the specific reasons for these exclusions—whether due to infection severity, glycemic control, vascular disease, or other factors—were not reported. This information is critical for assessing the external validity of the trial and understanding to which patient populations the results can be generalized [9, 10].

We acknowledge the authors' contribution to this important field and the transparency with which baseline data were presented. Nevertheless, these methodological considerations call for careful attention when interpreting the study's conclusions. We would appreciate the authors' answer to these concerns.

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### Author Contributions

**Xiang Ma:** supervision, writing – review and editing. **Qingqing Shan:** conceptualization, writing – original draft.

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### Ethics Statement

The authors have nothing to report.

### Consent

The authors have nothing to report.

### Conflicts of Interest

The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

### Data Availability Statement

Data sharing is not applicable to this article as no datasets were generated or analysed during the current study.

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